

FreshMinds Academy: Summer Learning Syllabus

A curated collection of YouTube channels to help first-year university students build real-world skills across AI, business, productivity, communication & more [cite: 1, 2, 3, 4].

How to use this list: Pick one or two channels from each section and commit to watching 2–3 videos per week. You don't need to watch everything — consistency beats volume [cite: 5, 6].

AI & Technology

Channel	Why Watch It
Danny Why	Best guide for starting a faceless YouTube channel with AI tools [cite: 8].
Liam Ottley	Practical AI automation workflows and online business ideas [cite: 8].
Tina Huang	Ex-Meta data scientist. Condensed tutorials on AI, data science & careers [cite: 8].
Dan Martell	AI-powered productivity, SaaS business strategies, and founder mindset [cite: 8].
Fireship	Complex programming topics explained in 100 seconds [cite: 8].
Matthew Berman	In-depth, up-to-date reviews of the latest AI tools and workflows [cite: 8].

Business & Marketing

Channel	Why Watch It
Alex Hormozi	Masterclass-level thinking on building offers, sales, and scaling businesses [cite: 10].

Jordan Platten	Best channel for learning SMMA and digital marketing from scratch [cite: 10].
The Futur	Teaches creatives how to price their work and think like professionals [cite: 10].
Codie Sanchez	Contrarian business thinking — how to find opportunities others overlook [cite: 10].

Productivity & Personal Development

Channel	Why Watch It
Ali Abdaal	Gold standard for study systems, productivity, and building a creator business [cite: 12].
Thomas Frank	Note-taking, Notion, Obsidian, and deep study strategies [cite: 12].
Huberman Lab	Science-backed strategies for sleep, focus, and optimizing your brain [cite: 12].

Communication & Confidence

Channel	Why Watch It
Charisma on Command	Breaks down real speeches to teach persuasion and presence [cite: 14].
TED Talks	Gold standard for learning how to present ideas with clarity [cite: 14].
Jeff Su	Practical, beginner-friendly career and communication skills [cite: 14].



Tech Awareness, Inspiration & Finance

Channel	Why Watch It
Silicon Valley Girl	Interviews with tech CEOs, AI founders, and industry leaders [cite: 16].
Cleo Abram	Optimistic, beautifully produced videos explaining future technology [cite: 16].
Veritasium	Makes complex science and physics fascinating [cite: 16].
Graham Stephan	Investing, saving, and real estate basics for young adults [cite: 18].